COVID-19: the first 90 days

A digest of World Health Organization situation reports and national announcements, 31 December 2019 to 21 April 2020. Prepared as demo material for AIGIS.

January: a cluster in Wuhan

31 December 2019. The Wuhan Municipal Health Commission in Wuhan, Hubei, China reports a cluster of 27 pneumonia cases of unknown cause, many linked to the Huanan Seafood Wholesale Market.

7 January 2020. Chinese authorities in Wuhan identify a novel coronavirus as the cause. **11 January.** The first death is reported in Wuhan, a 61-year-old man who had visited the market.

13 January. Thailand confirms the first case outside China, a traveler from Wuhan in Bangkok. **16 January.** Japan reports its first case in Kanagawa Prefecture. **20 January.** South Korea confirms a case at Incheon airport. **21 January.** The United States confirms its first case in Snohomish County, Washington.

23 January. Wuhan is placed under lockdown: flights, trains and buses out of the city of 11 million are halted. Within two days 15 more cities in Hubei follow, confining about 57 million people.

24 January. France reports the first cases in Europe, in Bordeaux and Paris. **25 January.** Australia confirms its first case in Melbourne, Victoria.

30 January. In Geneva the WHO Director-General declares a Public Health Emergency of International Concern. Situation Report 10 counts 7,818 confirmed cases worldwide, 82 of them in 18 countries outside China.

February: ships, Qom and Codogno

2 February. The first death outside China is reported in Manila, Philippines, a 44-year-old man from Wuhan.

5 February. The cruise ship Diamond Princess is quarantined at Yokohama, Japan with 3,711 people aboard; 712 of them will test positive.

11 February. WHO names the disease COVID-19.

19 February. Iran reports its first two cases, both fatal, in Qom. **21 February.** Italy reports a cluster in Codogno, Lombardy; by 23 February eleven towns in Lombardy and Veneto are sealed off, about 50,000 people.

28 February. Nigeria reports the first case in sub-Saharan Africa, in Lagos. **29 February.** The first death in the United States is reported in Kirkland, Washington, at a long-term care facility.

March: pandemic

8 March. Lombardy and 14 provinces are locked down, 16 million people. **9 March.** The lockdown is extended to all of Italy, 60 million people.

11 March. In Geneva WHO characterizes COVID-19 as a pandemic: 118,000 cases in 114 countries and 4,291 deaths.

13 March. The United States declares a national emergency in Washington, D.C. **14 March.** Spain declares a state of alarm, confining 47 million people from Madrid outward. **17 March.** France begins a nationwide confinement. **16 March.** Six counties around San Francisco order residents to shelter in place.

19 March. Italy's death toll of 3,405 passes China's. **23 March.** The United Kingdom announces a lockdown from London. **24 March.** India orders a 21-day lockdown of 1.3 billion people from New Delhi; the same day the Tokyo 2020 Olympic Games are postponed.

26 March. The United States becomes the country with the most confirmed cases, with New York City as the epicenter.

April: a million, then two

2 April. Confirmed cases worldwide pass one million. **7 April.** Japan declares a state of emergency for Tokyo and six prefectures; Singapore begins its "circuit breaker".

8 April. Wuhan lifts its lockdown after 76 days. **10 April.** Deaths worldwide pass 100,000.

21 April. Situation Report 92 counts about 2.4 million confirmed cases and 163,000 deaths, with the United States, Spain, Italy, France and Germany reporting the most cases.